Future Vision Institute

Future Vision English Course

INTERMEDIATE 2

B1.2 · CEFR

Student Book

Real conversations, big ideas, and science that matters

Stories • Topics • Science • Conversations



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STORY · LESSON 1

The Longest Line

Omar has been standing in a line since six in the morning. Read the story, then read Omar's story the next day.

- Say how long something has been happening
- Describe what people have been doing
- Compare it with a finished action

1 The story

It is eleven o'clock in the morning, and Omar is standing in a very long line outside a government office. He needs a new ID card, because his old one has been in the washing machine! He **has been waiting** here since six o'clock this morning. That's five hours.

The sun **has been shining** all morning, and everyone is hot and tired. The old man in front of Omar **has been reading** the same newspaper for two hours. Two women behind him **have been talking** about weddings since seven. A boy **has been selling** cold water up and down the line, and he **has been making** a lot of money.

Omar calls Adam. "What **have** you **been doing** all morning?" Adam asks. "Standing," says Omar. "Just standing. My legs hurt. I **have been standing** here so long that I know everyone's life story!" Adam laughs. "Are you sure you're in the right line?" "Of course I'm sure. It's the longest line here, so it's the right one."

At twelve o'clock, Omar finally reaches the window. The clerk looks at him. "ID cards? No, this line is for passports. ID cards are inside, in room three. There's no line there." Omar's mouth falls open. He walks inside. Room three is empty, and in five minutes he has a new ID card. When he comes out, the old man is still reading his newspaper. "Where **have** you **been**?" he asks. Omar smiles. "Learning a lesson!"

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Where is Omar standing?**
In a long line outside a government office.

2 **Why does he need a new ID card?**
His old one has been in the washing machine.

The Longest Line (continued)

2 Questions and answers (continued)

3 How long has he been waiting?
Since six o'clock. Five hours.

4 What has the old man been doing?
Reading the same newspaper for two hours.

5 What have the two women been talking about?
Weddings.

6 What has the boy been selling?
Cold water.

7 Has the boy been making money?
Yes, a lot.

8 What has Omar been doing all morning?
Standing.

9 Why does Omar think he is in the right line?
Because it's the longest line.

10 What is the line for?
Passports.

11 Where are the ID cards?
Inside, in room three.

12 How long does it take to get the new card?
Five minutes.

3 Point of view

Now Omar tells it the next day, when it is finished.

O

Yesterday, I **waited** in a very long line outside a government office. I needed a new ID card, because my old one had been in the washing machine! I **stood** there from six o'clock until twelve.

The sun **shone** all morning. The old man in front of me **read** the same newspaper for two hours, and the women behind me **talked** about weddings all morning. A boy **sold** cold water and **made** a lot of money.

At twelve, I finally **reached** the window. That line was for passports! The ID cards were inside, in room three, and there was no line at all. In five minutes, I **had** my new card.

So what did I learn? The longest line is not always the right one. Now, when people tell me, "I **have been waiting** for hours," I ask them, "Are you in the right line?"

The Longest Line (continued)

4 What did you learn?

You learned the present perfect continuous.

We use it for an action that started in the past and is still happening now, often to say how long.

STILL HAPPENING NOW	FINISHED: PAST SIMPLE
He **has been waiting** since six.	He **waited** for five hours.
The sun **has been shining** all morning.	The sun **shone** all morning.
They **have been talking** for hours.	They **talked** for hours.
What **have** you **been doing**?	What **did** you **do**?

have / has + been + -ing
I have been waiting. She has been reading.

for a length, since a start
for five hours · since six o'clock

Some verbs don't take -ing
know, like, want: I have known him for years.

QUESTIONS **How long have you been studying English?**

I've been studying it for three years.

5 New words

line	people waiting one behind another	**government**	the people who run a country
washing machine	a machine that washes clothes	**newspaper**	news printed on paper
reaches	gets to	**passports**	the small books you need to travel to other countries

TOPIC · LESSON 2

Helping Others

Sara has been volunteering at a children's hospital. Why do so many young people volunteer?

Talk about volunteering | Say how long you have been doing something | Give reasons

1 Read

For the last three months, Sara has been volunteering at a children's hospital in Khartoum every Friday morning. She isn't a doctor or a nurse. She reads stories, plays games, and helps the children with their homework.

A **volunteer** is someone who gives their time to help others without pay. Many young Sudanese people have been volunteering in recent years. They clean streets, teach children to read, give out food in Ramadan, and help families after floods.

Why do people volunteer? Some want to give back to their **community**. Others want to learn new **skills** or meet new people. And many say it simply makes them happy. "I've been feeling much better since I started," Sara says. "When a sick child laughs, it's the best feeling in the world."

Volunteering can also help your future. Employers often like to see it on a **résumé**, because it shows that you are responsible and good at working in a team. You don't need a lot of time. One hour a week can change someone's day. What have you been doing to help others?

2 Ways to help

teach help children read	**share food** in Ramadan	**after floods** help families clean and rebuild	**hospitals** read and play with sick children

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **How long has Sara been volunteering?**
For three months.

Helping Others (continued)

3 Questions and answers (continued)

2 What does she do at the hospital?
She reads stories, plays games, and helps the children with their homework.

3 What is a volunteer?
Someone who gives their time to help others without pay.

4 What have young Sudanese people been doing?
Cleaning streets, teaching children, giving out food, and helping after floods.

5 Why do employers like to see volunteering on a résumé?
It shows that you are responsible and good at working in a team.

6 How much time do you need?
One hour a week can change someone's day.

4 New words

volunteering	doing work for free to help others	**floods**	water that covers land that is usually dry
community	the people who live in a place	**employers**	people or companies that give jobs
résumé	a list of your education and your jobs	**responsible**	someone you can trust to do the right thing

CONVERSATION · LESSON 3

At the Doctor's

Describing how you feel and for how long

Describe symptoms · Say how long you have felt like this · Understand the doctor's advice

1 Read the conversation

Adam hasn't been feeling well. He visits a doctor at the health center.

DR	DOCTOR	Good morning, Adam. What seems to be the problem?
A	ADAM	I've been feeling tired, and I have a sore throat.
DR	DOCTOR	How long have you been feeling like this?
A	ADAM	For about four days. And I've been coughing a lot at night.

At the Doctor's (continued)

1 Read the conversation (continued)

DR	DOCTOR	Have you had a fever?
A	ADAM	Yes, a little. Since Tuesday.
DR	DOCTOR	Let me look at your throat. Hmm, it's red. Have you been drinking enough water?
A	ADAM	Not really. I've been studying a lot for my exams.
DR	DOCTOR	It's a throat infection. Take this medicine three times a day, drink a lot of water, and rest for a few days.
A	ADAM	Thank you, Doctor. I'll take a break from studying.

2 Useful phrases

THE DOCTOR ASKS
What seems to be the problem?

SAY HOW YOU FEEL
I've been feeling tired.

SAY HOW LONG
How long have you been feeling like this?
— For about four days.

DESCRIBE IT
I've been coughing a lot at night.

ANSWER
Have you had a fever?
— Yes, a little.

UNDERSTAND ADVICE
Take this medicine three times a day.

3 New words

sore throat	pain inside your neck when you swallow	**coughing**	pushing air out of your throat with a noise
fever	a body temperature that is too high	**infection**	an illness caused by very small living things
medicine	something you take to get better	**rest**	stop working and relax

STORY · LESSON 4

If I Were the Teacher

Hamza doesn't like homework, so he imagines a different school. Read the story, then read it from Hamza's point of view.

Imagine a different situation | Use if and would | Talk about what you would change

1 The story

Hamza is eight years old, and he doesn't like school very much. One evening, he is sitting at the kitchen table with his homework. He has been looking at the same math problem for twenty minutes. "If I **were** the teacher," he says, "there **wouldn't be** any homework."

Adam smiles. "Really? What else **would** you **change**?" Hamza thinks. "If I **were** the teacher, school **would start** at ten o'clock, not seven. We **would play** football every morning. And if a student **got** a bad grade, I **would give** him a cookie to feel better."

"And if the students **didn't listen**?" Adam asks. "I **would** never **shout**," says Hamza. "I **would tell** them a funny story, and they **would listen**." "What **would** you **do** if the principal **came** to your class?" "If the principal **came**, I **would ask** him to play football with us!"

Their mother is listening at the door. "That sounds like a wonderful school, Hamza," she says. "But if you **were** the teacher, you **would need** to know the answer to that math problem." Hamza looks at his homework. Then he looks at Adam. "Adam, if you **helped** me, I **would finish** faster." Adam laughs. "And if I **helped** you every night, you **would** never **learn**!" But he sits down and helps him anyway.

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **How old is Hamza?**
Eight.

2 **Does he like school?**
Not very much.

If I Were the Teacher (continued)

2 Questions and answers (continued)

3 How long has he been looking at the math problem?
For twenty minutes.

4 What wouldn't there be if Hamza were the teacher?
Any homework.

5 What time would school start?
At ten o'clock.

6 What would they do every morning?
Play football.

7 What would he give a student who got a bad grade?
A cookie.

8 Would he shout if the students didn't listen?
No, he wouldn't. He would tell them a funny story.

9 What would he ask the principal?
To play football with them.

10 Who is listening at the door?
Their mother.

11 What would Hamza need to know if he were the teacher?
The answer to the math problem.

12 Does Adam help him in the end?
Yes, he does.

3 Point of view Now Hamza tells it.

HA

I'm eight, and I don't like homework. Tonight, I've been looking at the same math problem for twenty minutes. If I **were** the teacher, there **wouldn't be** any homework!

If I **were** the teacher, school **would start** at ten o'clock, and we **would play** football every morning. If a student **got** a bad grade, I **would give** him a cookie.

I **would** never **shout**. If the students **didn't listen**, I **would tell** them a funny story. And if the principal **came** to my class, I **would ask** him to play football with us!

Mom says that if I **were** the teacher, I **would need** to know the answer to my math problem. OK, maybe she's right. But if I **were** Adam, I **would help** my little brother every night!

If I Were the Teacher (continued)

4 What did you learn?

You learned the second conditional.

We use it for situations that are not real now, or not likely. We imagine them.

IF + PAST	WOULD + VERB
If I **were** the teacher,	there **wouldn't be** any homework.
If a student **got** a bad grade,	I **would give** him a cookie.
If the principal **came**,	I **would ask** him to play.
If you **helped** me,	I **would finish** faster.

Not real: the past after if
If I were the teacher (but I'm not).

were for everyone
If I were, if he were, if she were.

First or second?
Possible: If I study, I'll pass. Imagined: If I were the teacher, I'd…

QUESTIONS **What would you do if you were the teacher?**

If I were the teacher, I'd tell funny stories.

5 New words

math	the study of numbers	**grade**	a number or letter that shows how good your work is
shout	speak very loudly	**principal**	the head of a school
wonderful	very, very good	**anyway**	even so

TOPIC · LESSON 5

Dream Jobs

Four students answer one question. If you could choose any job, what would it be?

Talk about dream jobs | Imagine with if and would | Give reasons for your choice

1 Read

We asked four students at Future Vision Institute one question. "If you could choose any job in the world, what would it be?" Here are their answers.

Adam, 20: "I would be a pilot, of course! If I flew for an airline, I would see a new city every week. And I would fly my grandfather to Port Sudan for free."

Huda, 19: "If I could choose, I would be a teacher, like Mr. Ali. I would teach in the village where my mother grew up, because there aren't enough teachers there."

Omar, 21: "I'm already a manager, but if I had more money, I would open my own company. It would repair phones and computers in every city in Sudan."

Sara, 19: "I would be an engineer who builds bridges. If Sudan had more bridges, people wouldn't wait for hours to cross the Nile."

What about you? If you had the chance, what would you do, and what would you need to learn to get there? The first step is often closer than you think.

2 Their dream jobs

Adam	Huda	Omar	Sara
a pilot	a village teacher	his own company	an engineer who builds bridges

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What question did they ask the students?**
If you could choose any job in the world, what would it be?

2 **What would Adam see if he flew for an airline?**
A new city every week.

Dream Jobs (continued)

3 Questions and answers (continued)

3 **Where would Huda teach?**
In the village where her mother grew up.

4 **What would Omar do if he had more money?**
Open his own company.

5 **What would Sara build?**
Bridges.

6 **Why does Sudan need more bridges, says Sara?**
So people wouldn't wait for hours to cross the Nile.

4 New words

choose	decide which one you want	**airline**	a company that flies planes
grew up	lived as a child until she was an adult	**chance**	a time when something is possible
step	one of many actions you do to reach a goal	**closer**	nearer

CONVERSATION · LESSON 6

If I Were You...

Asking for and giving advice about a big decision

Ask for advice | Give advice with If I were you | Talk about possible results

1 Read the conversation

Omar has a big decision to make. He talks to Adam in the café.

OMAR	Adam, I need some advice. The university has offered me a place in computer science.
ADAM	That's great news! So what's the problem?
OMAR	If I went to university, I would have to stop working at the shop. And I need the money.
ADAM	Hmm. Can you study part-time?
OMAR	Maybe. But if I did that, it would take six years, not four.
ADAM	If I were you, I'd talk to Mr. Kamal first. He may let you work fewer hours.

If I Were You… (continued)

1 Read the conversation (continued)

OMAR	That's a good idea. What would you do if he said no?
ADAM	I'd still go to university. A degree would help you open your own company one day.
OMAR	You're right. I'll talk to him tomorrow.
ADAM	Good luck! And if you need help with math, call Sara, not me!

2 Useful phrases

ASK FOR ADVICE
I need some advice.

EXPLAIN THE PROBLEM
If I went to university, I would have to stop working.

GIVE ADVICE
If I were you, I'd talk to Mr. Kamal.

ASK "WHAT IF"
What would you do if he said no?

AGREE
You're right.

WISH GOOD LUCK
Good luck!

3 New words

advice — what you tell someone they should do

fewer — not as many

offered — said that someone can have something

degree — what you get when you finish university

STORY · LESSON 7

What Did Mr. Ali Say?

A message about a test travels from student to student, and it changes on the way. Read the story, then read the exact words people said.

Report what people said | Use said and told | Pass on a message correctly

1 The story

On Wednesday, Mr. Ali was sick, so a new teacher, Ms. Nadia, came to class instead. At the end of the lesson, she gave the students a message from Mr. Ali. She said that there would be a short test on Sunday. She said that it would be about the stories from Units 1 and 2, and she told the students to bring a pencil.

After class, Adam called Omar, who had been absent that day. "Ms. Nadia said that the test was on Sunday," he said. "She told us that it was about Units 1 and 2." Then Omar called Huda. "Adam said that the test was on Sunday, about Unit 2."

Huda sent a message to the class group. "Omar says there's a test on Sunday about Unit 2, or maybe Monday?" Then someone wrote, "I heard that there was no test!" By Saturday night, nobody knew what was true. Some students said that the test had been canceled. Others said that it was on Monday.

On Sunday morning, Mr. Ali came back. Half of the students had pencils, and the other half looked very surprised. "What's wrong?" Mr. Ali asked. Sara explained what everyone had said. Mr. Ali laughed. "This is a perfect lesson," he said. "Today, there is no test. Today, we are going to learn reported speech!"

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Why didn't Mr. Ali come on Wednesday?**
He was sick.

2 **Who came instead?**
A new teacher, Ms. Nadia.

3 **What did she say about the test?**
She said that there would be a short test on Sunday.

4 **What did she say it would be about?**
The stories from Units 1 and 2.

What Did Mr. Ali Say? (continued)

2 Questions and answers (continued)

5 **What did she tell the students to bring?**
A pencil.

6 **Who did Adam call?**
Omar, who had been absent.

7 **What did Omar tell Huda?**
That the test was on Sunday, about Unit 2.

8 **Where did Huda send a message?**
To the class group.

9 **What did someone write?**
That there was no test.

10 **What did some students say on Saturday night?**
That the test had been canceled.

11 **How many students had pencils on Sunday?**
Half of them.

12 **What did Mr. Ali say they were going to learn?**
Reported speech!

3 Point of view

Now Sara gives the exact words that people said.

S

On Wednesday, Ms. Nadia said, "There **will be** a short test on Sunday. It **is** about the stories from Units 1 and 2. **Bring** a pencil, please."

After class, Adam told Omar, "The test **is** on Sunday. It**'s** about Units 1 and 2." And Omar told Huda, "Adam says the test **is** on Sunday, about Unit 2."

Huda wrote in our group, "Omar says there's a test on Sunday about Unit 2, or maybe Monday?" Then someone wrote, "There**'s** no test!" And others wrote, "The test **has been** canceled!"

On Sunday, Mr. Ali laughed. "Today, there **is** no test. Today, we **are going to** learn reported speech!"

What Did Mr. Ali Say? (continued)

4 What did you learn?

You learned reported speech.

We use it to tell other people what someone said. The verb usually moves one step back into the past.

WHAT SHE SAID	WHAT WE REPORT
"There will be a test."	She said that there would be a test.
"The test is on Sunday."	He said that the test was on Sunday.
"The test has been canceled."	They said that the test had been canceled.
"Bring a pencil."	She told us to bring a pencil.

One step back: is → was · will → would
has been → had been, can → could

said … or told + a person
She said that… · She told us that…

Orders: told … to
She told us to bring a pencil.

QUESTIONS **What did the teacher say?** She said that the test would be on Sunday.

5 New words

instead	in the place of someone or something	**heard**	the past of hear
true	correct; real	**canceled**	stopped; it will not happen
half	one of two equal parts	**explained**	said how or why something happened

CONVERSATION · LESSON 8

Passing On a Message

Telling people what was said in a meeting

Report what someone said | Report questions and orders | Check that news is true

1 Read the conversation

Omar has had a meeting with Mr. Kamal. Back at the new shop, a worker asks him about it.

W	WORKER	How was the meeting, Omar? What did Mr. Kamal say?
O	OMAR	He said that the shop had done very well this month.
W	WORKER	Great! Did he say anything about the new screens?
O	OMAR	Yes. He said that they would arrive on Thursday.
W	WORKER	And did he ask about the broken laptop?
O	OMAR	He asked if we had fixed it yet. I told him we were waiting for a part.
W	WORKER	What else did he say?
O	OMAR	He told us to be extra careful with customers' data. And he said that everyone would get a bonus!
W	WORKER	A bonus? Did he really say that?
O	OMAR	He did! He said that we had all worked very hard.

2 Useful phrases

ASK ABOUT A MEETING
What did Mr. Kamal say?

REPORT NEWS
He said that the shop had done very well.

REPORT THE FUTURE
He said that they would arrive on Thursday.

REPORT A QUESTION
He asked if we had fixed it yet.

REPORT AN ORDER
He told us to be extra careful.

CHECK
Did he really say that?
— He did!

3 New words

meeting — a time when people meet to talk about work

extra — more than usual

bonus — extra money for good work

part — one piece of a machine

data — information on a computer or a phone

STORY · LESSON 9

It Must Be a Ghost!

Strange sounds in Omar's shop late at night. Read the story, then read it from Adam's point of view.

Guess what something is | Say how sure you are | Use must | might and can't

1 The story

It is late on Thursday night. Omar has closed the new shop, and he is walking home when he remembers his keys. He goes back. Inside, the shop is dark and quiet. Then he hears it, a strange, high sound. Beep… beep… beep. It is coming from the back room.

Omar's heart starts to beat fast. He calls Adam. "There's someone in the shop!" "It **can't be** a person," Adam says. "You locked the door, didn't you?" "Yes, I did." "Then it **might be** a cat. Cats sometimes come in through windows." "Cats don't go beep," says Omar. "It **must be** something electronic."

Adam arrives ten minutes later with a flashlight. They stand at the door of the back room. The sound stops. Then it starts again, louder. "Maybe it's a ghost," Adam whispers. "It **can't be** a ghost," Omar whispers back, but his voice is shaking. "It **could be** the alarm. Or it **might be** one of the phones on the shelf."

Omar opens the door slowly and turns on the light. On the shelf, there are twenty phones waiting for repair. One of them is shining and beeping. Omar picks it up. The screen says, "11:00 p.m. Time to take your medicine, Grandma!" The two friends look at each other and laugh so hard they can't stand up. "It **must be** Mrs. Fatima's phone," says Omar. "She brought it in yesterday. I'll call her tomorrow and remind her!"

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **When does Omar go back to the shop?**
Late on Thursday night.

2 **Why does he go back?**
He remembers his keys.

3 **What does he hear?**
A strange, high sound: beep, beep, beep.

4 **Why can't it be a person?**
Because Omar locked the door.

It Must Be a Ghost! (continued)

2 Questions and answers (continued)

5 **What does Adam think it might be?**
A cat.

6 **Why can't it be a cat?**
Cats don't go beep.

7 **What does Adam bring?**
A flashlight.

8 **What does Adam whisper?**
Maybe it's a ghost.

9 **What does Omar think it could be?**
The alarm, or one of the phones on the shelf.

10 **How many phones are on the shelf?**
Twenty.

11 **What does the phone's screen say?**
Time to take your medicine, Grandma!

12 **Whose phone must it be?**
Mrs. Fatima's.

3 Point of view

Now Adam tells it, and how he guessed.

A

It's late on Thursday, and Omar calls me. He's scared. "There's someone in the shop!" It **can't be** a person, I think. He locked the door. It **might be** a cat. But cats don't go beep. So it **must be** something electronic.

I get my flashlight and go to the shop. We stand at the door of the back room. The beeping stops, then it starts again, louder. "Maybe it's a ghost," I whisper. "It **can't be** a ghost," Omar says, but his voice is shaking. "It **could be** the alarm."

Omar opens the door and turns on the light. One of the phones on the shelf is beeping. The screen says, "Time to take your medicine, Grandma!"

We laugh so hard we can't stand up. It **must be** Mrs. Fatima's phone. Some ghost!

It Must Be a Ghost! (continued)

4 What did you learn?

You learned must, might and can't for guessing.

We use them when we are not completely sure, to show how sure we are.

HOW SURE?	EXAMPLE
Almost sure: yes	It must be something electronic.
Maybe	It might be a cat. · It could be the alarm.
Almost sure: no	It can't be a person. The door is locked.

modal + be or another verb
It must be. She might know.

must for yes, can't for no
Not: it mustn't be a person.

might · could mean maybe
It might be a cat. It could be the alarm.

QUESTIONS **Whose phone is it?** It must be Mrs. Fatima's.

5 New words

beep	a short high sound from a machine	**electronic**	working with electricity and computer parts
ghost	the spirit of a dead person that some people believe in	**whispers**	speaks very quietly
shaking	moving quickly from side to side	**remind**	help someone remember

SCIENCE · LESSON 10

Is There Life on Mars?

What scientists know about the red planet, and what they think is possible.

- Explain what scientists know
- Say what is possible with might and could
- Use can't for what is almost impossible

1 Read

For hundreds of years, people have looked at the red planet in the night sky and asked the same question. Is there life on **Mars**?

Mars is the fourth planet from the sun. It is much colder than the Earth, about minus sixty degrees on most days, and its air is very thin. Today, there is no liquid water on its surface. So life there can't be easy.

But scientists have found some exciting clues. Robots called **rovers**, like Curiosity and Perseverance, have been exploring Mars for years. They have found dry riverbeds and rocks that formed in water. This means that Mars had rivers and lakes billions of years ago.

Where there was water, there could also be life, very small living things called **microbes**. They might still live deep under the ground, where it is warmer and there could be ice.

Perseverance has been collecting rock samples since 2021. In the future, these samples could come back to Earth, where scientists can study them in labs. If they found even one tiny microbe, it would be one of the biggest discoveries in history.

2 Mars in numbers

4th planet from the sun	**−60°** on most days	**no water** on the surface, today	**rovers** exploring since 2012

DID YOU KNOW? A day on Mars is only about 40 minutes longer than a day on Earth, but a year on Mars is 687 Earth days.

Is There Life on Mars? (continued)

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Which planet from the sun is Mars?**
The fourth.

2 **Is Mars colder or warmer than the Earth?**
Much colder, about minus sixty degrees on most days.

3 **Is there liquid water on Mars today?**
No, there isn't.

4 **What have the rovers found?**
Dry riverbeds and rocks that formed in water.

5 **What does this mean?**
Mars had rivers and lakes billions of years ago.

6 **Where might microbes still live?**
Deep under the ground.

7 **What has Perseverance been doing since 2021?**
Collecting rock samples.

8 **What would happen if scientists found one tiny microbe?**
It would be one of the biggest discoveries in history.

4 New words

planet	a large round object that goes around a sun
exploring	traveling around a place to learn about it
samples	small pieces that are taken to study
surface	the outside or top of something
microbes	living things too small to see
discoveries	things that are found for the first time

CONVERSATION · LESSON 11

Whose Bag Is This?

Guessing who something belongs to

Ask who something belongs to | Guess with must | might and can't | Use clues

1 Read the conversation

After class, Mr. Ali finds a bag under a desk. Sara and Huda are still in the room.

MA	MR. ALI	Someone has left a bag under this desk. Whose is it?
S	SARA	It can't be mine. My bag is here.
H	HUDA	Is there a name on it?
MA	MR. ALI	No name. But there's a football in it, and a book about planes.
S	SARA	A book about planes? It must be Adam's!
H	HUDA	But Omar plays football, too. It might be his.
MA	MR. ALI	There's also a phone charger and a receipt from a phone shop.
S	SARA	Hmm. That could be Omar's. He works at a phone shop.
H	HUDA	Wait, there's a sandwich in paper. It says, "For Adam. Love, Mom."
S	SARA	Then it must be Adam's. Mystery solved!

2 Useful phrases

ASK WHO IT BELONGS TO
Whose is it?

SAY NO
It can't be mine.

SAY ALMOST YES
It must be Adam's!

SAY MAYBE
It might be his. · That could be Omar's.

LOOK FOR CLUES
Is there a name on it?

FINISH
Mystery solved!

3 New words

whose — of which person

charger — a cable that gives power to a phone

mine — the one that belongs to me

solved — found the answer to

STORY · LESSON 12

Sara Learns to Drive

Sara decides to learn to drive, and her father offers to teach her. Read the story, then read it from her father's point of view.

Talk about learning something new | Use -ing and to after verbs | Tell how you kept trying

1 The story

Sara has always **enjoyed solving** problems, but there was one problem she couldn't solve. She couldn't drive. Her university is far from her home, and she was **tired of waiting** for buses. So last month, she **decided to learn**.

Her father, an engineer, **offered to teach** her. "Driving is like engineering," he said. "You **need to think** before you act." On the first day, Sara **forgot to look** in the mirror. On the second day, she **forgot to use** the brake! Her father **stopped smiling** for a moment.

Sara didn't give up. She **kept practicing** every Friday morning, when the streets were quiet. She **practiced parking** behind the house, between two old chairs, and she watched videos **about changing** gears. Slowly, she **stopped feeling** nervous, and she **started to enjoy** it.

Last week, Sara passed her driving test on the first try. "I **want to thank** my teacher," she said, and she hugged her father. That evening, she **offered to drive** the whole family to the river. Lina was excited, and her mother was a little nervous. And her father? He **pretended to read** a newspaper in the back seat, but he couldn't **stop smiling**.

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **What has Sara always enjoyed?**
Solving problems.

2 **Why did she decide to learn to drive?**
She was tired of waiting for buses.

3 **Who offered to teach her?**
Her father.

4 **What did he say driving is like?**
Engineering.

Sara Learns to Drive (continued)

2 Questions and answers (continued)

5 What did Sara forget to do on the first day?
To look in the mirror.

6 What did she forget on the second day?
To use the brake!

7 When did she keep practicing?
Every Friday morning.

8 Where did she practice parking?
Behind the house, between two old chairs.

9 What did she watch videos about?
Changing gears.

10 When did she pass her driving test?
Last week, on the first try.

11 What did she offer to do that evening?
To drive the whole family to the river.

12 What did her father pretend to do?
To read a newspaper in the back seat.

3 Point of view

Now Sara's father tells it.

F

My daughter Sara has always **enjoyed solving** problems. Last month, she **decided to learn** to drive, and I **offered to teach** her. "You **need to think** before you act," I told her.

On the first day, she **forgot to look** in the mirror. On the second day, she **forgot to use** the brake! I **stopped smiling** for a moment, I must say.

But she **kept practicing** every Friday. She **practiced parking** between two old chairs behind the house, and she watched videos **about changing** gears. Slowly, she **stopped feeling** nervous and **started to enjoy** it.

Last week, she passed her test on the first try. That evening, she drove us all to the river. I **pretended to read** a newspaper in the back seat, but I couldn't **stop smiling**.

Sara Learns to Drive (continued)

4 What did you learn?

You learned verb + -ing and verb + to.

After some verbs we use the -ing form. After others we use to + verb. Learn each verb with its partner.

VERB + -ING	VERB + TO + VERB
enjoy **solving**	decide **to learn**
keep **practicing**	offer **to teach**
stop **smiling**	forget **to look**
be tired of **waiting**	pretend **to read**

-ing after enjoy, keep, stop, finish
She kept practicing.

to after decide, offer, want, need, forget
She decided to learn.

After about, of, at: -ing
videos about changing gears · tired of waiting

QUESTIONS **What do you enjoy doing on the weekend?** I enjoy playing football.

5 New words

mirror	glass where you can see yourself	**brake**	the part of a car that stops it
give up	stop trying	**gears**	the parts of a car that change its speed
try	here: one time that you do a test	**pretended**	acted as if something was true

SCIENCE · LESSON 13

Gum Arabic

The tree from Sudan that is in your sweets, your drinks, and your medicine.

- Explain how a product is made
- Use -ing forms as subjects
- Talk about Sudan's place in the world

1 Read

Have you ever eaten a sweet, had a soft drink, or taken a pill? Then you have probably used something from Sudan, **gum arabic**.

Gum arabic is a natural gum from the **acacia** tree, which grows across the dry lands of Africa. Sudan is the biggest producer in the world. In some years, it has produced more than half of all the gum arabic on Earth, mostly from the Kordofan and Darfur regions.

Collecting the gum is slow work. In the dry season, farmers make small cuts in the bark of the trees. This is called **tapping**. Over the next weeks, a thick liquid comes out of the cuts and slowly becomes hard in the sun. Then the farmers start picking the hard pieces, which look like small yellow stones, by hand.

The gum is sold to companies all over the world. It is used to keep drinks mixed, to make sweets soft, to cover pills, and even to make ink and paint.

The acacia tree also helps the land. Its roots stop the sand from moving, and it can grow where other trees can't. So planting acacia trees is good for farmers and for the environment.

2 From tree to world

1 tapping
farmers cut the bark

2 drying
the gum becomes hard

3 picking
pieces are picked by hand

4 selling
sent all over the world

DID YOU KNOW? The "gum arabic belt" is a long line of acacia trees across Africa, south of the Sahara, from Senegal in the west to Sudan in the east.

Gum Arabic (continued)

3 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Where does gum arabic come from?**
From the acacia tree.

2 **Which country is the biggest producer?**
Sudan.

3 **Where in Sudan does most of the gum come from?**
Kordofan and Darfur.

4 **What is tapping?**
Making small cuts in the bark of the trees.

5 **What happens to the liquid in the sun?**
It slowly becomes hard.

6 **How are the pieces picked?**
By hand.

7 **What is gum arabic used for?**
Drinks, sweets, pills, ink, and paint.

8 **How does the acacia tree help the land?**
Its roots stop the sand from moving.

4 New words

natural	from nature, not made by people
regions	large areas of a country
roots	the parts of a plant under the ground
producer	a country or company that makes something
bark	the hard outside of a tree
environment	the air, water, and land around us